

Michael Foster

Python Software Engineer

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Summary

Accomplished Python Software Engineer with 9 years of experience architecting scalable production systems. Proven expertise in optimizing PostgreSQL and Redis performance while leveraging FastAPI to drive cross-functional engineering initiatives. Seeking to deliver high-impact technical solutions within a collaborative Austin-based team.

Experience

Software Engineer — DataPipe (2018 – Present · Austin, USA)

- Engineered high-concurrency data ingestion services using Python and Kafka to process millions of events daily.
- Optimized PostgreSQL schema performance and indexing strategies, resulting in a 30% reduction in query latency.
- Authored comprehensive technical documentation and operational runbooks to streamline team onboarding and incident response.
- Accelerated CI/CD delivery cycles by 40% through the implementation of automated Python-based deployment workflows.

Software Engineer — NovaLabs (2015 – 2017 · Austin, USA)

- Collaborated with product stakeholders to translate business requirements into scalable features using Python and Django.
- Enforced rigorous code quality standards by implementing comprehensive pytest suites and conducting peer-led architectural reviews.
- Standardized internal development processes by creating detailed technical specifications and system maintenance guides.
- Reduced manual overhead by automating repetitive infrastructure tasks, significantly improving team deployment velocity.

Junior Developer — BrightStack (2011 – 2014 · Austin, USA)

- Contributed to the full software development lifecycle, delivering incremental feature updates in a fast-paced Python environment.
- Enhanced application reliability by integrating automated testing frameworks and participating in regular code quality audits.
- Maintained essential project documentation and troubleshooting manuals to support ongoing system stability.
- Streamlined development operations by automating routine build and testing scripts, increasing overall team productivity.

Projects

Internal reporting toolkit — Developed a lightweight ETL pipeline and visualization dashboard using Python to track and report team performance metrics.

Open-source side project — Maintained an open-source utility library focused on implementing efficient Python design patterns and reusable code structures.

Education

BSc Computer Science — University of Texas at Austin (2017)

Earned a BSc in Computer Science with a focus on systems architecture and data structures, graduating in 2017.

BSc Software Engineering — University of Edinburgh (2013)

Undergraduate studies at University of Edinburgh, foundational degree before BSc Computer Science.

Skills

Python · PostgreSQL · Redis · FastAPI · pytest · Django · Docker · AWS · Kafka · gRPC

Languages

English